

Do-It-Yourself Investing

Ellen Douglas Williamson

So you don't like bankers and brokers and bullish-and-bearish advisors and being pushed around by investment counsel men who act as if it were their money? So you'd rather live with your own mistakes? Frankly, so would I.

It's the same as when you paint the living room a clear lemon yellow and all the guests look as if they were getting over hepatitis, it's better to have it your own whimsical decision than to have to look at it every day and get madder and madder at that two-headed interior decorator. If it's your fault, it's an interesting experiment; if the decorator did it, you run the risk of a complete collapse from pure rage.

Now, if you buy yourself 100 shares of the Little Daisy Window Washing Company at 20 and it sinks promptly to 10 and you have only yourself to blame, at least you can chalk it up to experience or bad timing or poor health. But if someone else talked you into buying it—well! It's almost too difficult to live with your own infuriation—how *could* that so-and-so pick up such a stinker of a stock—if he'd been an alchemist he couldn't have made it go down faster—he gets his tips from his grandmother's ouija board, that's what he does.